

ZHANIBEK DARIMBEK

Applied AI / Agent Engineer

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EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer — Sema US (Remote) Oct 2025 – Aug 2026

Liz — an AI agent answering engineering-org questions (delivery health, process leakage, planning risk) over a company's issue trackers, code repos, docs and comms. Tech lead, 5 engineers; hands-on across design, build and ship.

- Took Liz from a proof of concept over Jira and GitHub to the production system, ingesting 12+ sources across code, issues, docs, chats, calls and email, with hybrid retrieval over pgvector.
- Moved the agent off live provider APIs onto read-only SQL views over a mirrored layer covering all sources, so aggregation runs in SQL. Cost per run down 52%, wall-clock 68%, variance halved.
- Designed the agent's tool interfaces across sources differing in size, structure and update rate, and shipped the standard as an agent skill — 5 engineers adding tools weekly, no repeated manual review.
- Replaced model-driven tool calls with programmatic tool calling in the Monty sandbox: multi-MB tool outputs never reach the context window, and aggregation is exact rather than sampled.
- Built offline trajectory-level evals on production traces, scoring answer quality, tool-call correctness, latency, token use and failure counts across repeated runs on frozen inputs.
- Moved the agent onto Pydantic AI's Capabilities/Harness, replacing home-grown abstractions for context compaction, code mode, subagents and guardrails with maintained framework primitives.

Senior Software Engineer — Monite Germany (Remote) May 2024 – Oct 2025

- Built accounts-receivable, payments and accounting-automation APIs consumed by dozens of B2B platforms — vertical SaaS, other fintechs and payment providers.
- Shipped an AI feature for drafting AR invoices from natural language, using Pydantic AI with tool calling grounded in a company's invoice history; delivered as an API resource and a ready-to-issue PDF.
- Owned the AR document and billing surface: PDF customization with partner branding, recurring invoices with flexible scheduling, delivery notes, invoice financing and Xero/QuickBooks sync.
- Stood up an internal MCP server that pulls context from Notion, Jira, Confluence, and GitHub into one space for coding agents, cutting context switching and ticket-to-deploy time.

CTO — ioka group Almaty, Kazakhstan Nov 2020 – May 2024

Founding engineer, then CTO of a fintech and travel ecosystem in Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan; 10 engineers.

- Built the payment gateway from scratch and grew it to 80+ merchants and 3M+ transactions a year, ~\$400M in annual volume, working directly with customers' developers on integration and custom flows.
- Shipped APIs and mobile SDKs for card acquiring, Apple Pay, Google Pay, BNPL, saved cards, subscriptions, P2P, payment links, and payouts.
- Built multi-acquirer orchestration with routing by availability, cost, and payment scheme.
- Led PCI DSS Level 1 certification through QSA audits, scans and remediation, and held it across quarterly and annual cycles.
- Built ioka Travel's backend with GDS and railway ticket provider integrations, deployed end to end to first customers in Uzbekistan.

Software Engineer — Kazdream Tech Astana, Kazakhstan May 2019 – Nov 2020

- Automated data collection from 20+ social, messaging and web/mobile sources; built crawlers feeding scalable B2B APIs and real-time systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI / LLM: Multi-agent systems, tool/function calling, sandboxed code execution, hybrid retrieval (pgvector + full-text, RRF), MCP servers, agent guardrails & trajectory analysis; Pydantic AI, provider SDKs (OpenAI / Anthropic / Gemini); familiar: LangChain / LangGraph

Backend: Python (async), FastAPI, Django + DRF, aiohttp, API design

Data & Infra: PostgreSQL (+ pgvector), Redis, RabbitMQ, Temporal, Docker; Logfire / OpenTelemetry, per-request LLM cost accounting

EDUCATION

M.Sc., Data Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2020 – 2022

Thesis: Sequential Deep Learning Models for Human Skeleton-based Gait Recognition

B.Sc., Computer Science — Nazarbayev University, Astana 2016 – 2020